

» IBISES, BITTERNS, HERONS, AND PELICANS

AFRICAN SPOONBILL*Platalea alba*

F: Threskiornithidae

The only spoonbill confined to wetlands of Africa, this species is characterized by its red face and legs.



90–92 cm
35–36 in



80–90 cm
32–35 in

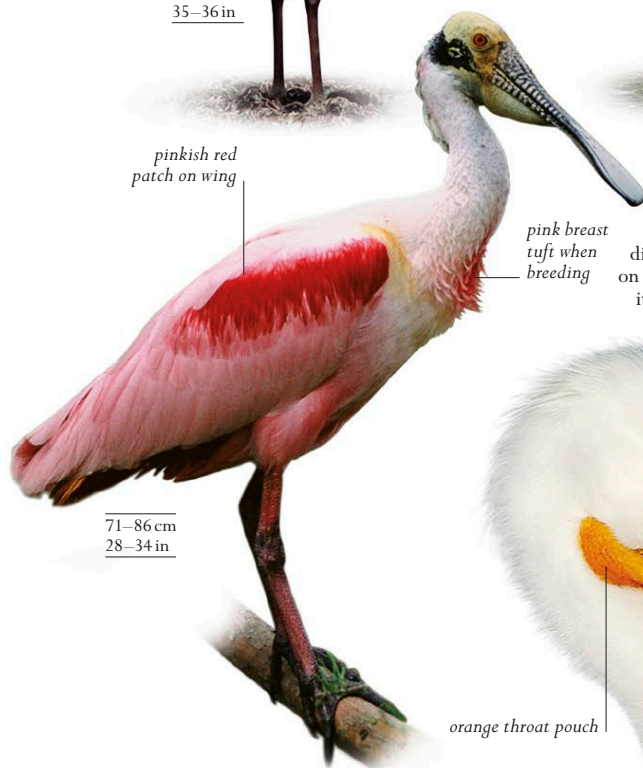
EURASIAN SPOONBILL*Platalea leucorodia*

F: Threskiornithidae

This species breeds in Eurasia and overwinters in Africa. Mature birds have a broad yellow tip to the black bill.



1.2–1.5 m
4–5 ft



pinkish red
patch on wing

pink breast
tuft when
breeding

ROSEATE SPOONBILL*Platalea ajaja*

F: Threskiornithidae

Like other spoonbills, this distinctive American species feeds on small aquatic animals by swinging its bill from side to side in water.

71–86 cm
28–34 in

orange throat pouch

all-white plumage

**AMERICAN WHITE PELICAN**
Pelecanus erythrorhynchos
F: Pelecanidae

This pelican breeds on inland lakes of N. America and overwinters on the coasts. In the breeding season, it develops a flat “horn” on its bill.



56 cm
22 in

HAMMERKOP*Scopus umbretta*

F: Scopidae

This African wetland bird builds huge, heavy-walled nests using sticks and mud to protect its young, who are often left for long periods.

1.3–1.6 m
4¼–5¼ ft



1.3–1.5 m
4¼–5 ft

SPOT-BILLED PELICAN*Pelecanus philippensis*

F: Pelecanidae

A species from S. Asia, the spot-billed pelican, like most other pelicans, fishes by scooping prey while swimming on the water surface.



bold head and
neck pattern

1–1.4 m
3¼–4½ ft

BROWN PELICAN*Pelecanus occidentalis*

F: Pelecanidae

This grey and brown pelican from the S. USA to S. America is a coastal-breeding species and, unlike other pelicans, plunge-dives for fish.